One of the reasons for using an integration router is to distribute the load among different actors and improve system performance when many messages are being processed. These can be local actors (scale up) or actors on remote servers (scale out). A key Akka argument for using scaling is the ease of routing.

In the camera example, the detection step—analyzing the photo—takes a relatively long time to process. To be able to parallelize this task, you use a router. In figure 6.1 (reproduced here for you as figure 6.4), you see that the camera—as a router—can send the message to one of the photo processors.

When the camera receives a message, it decides which photo processors it should send the batch of photos to. This decision is based on a *routing strategy*.

